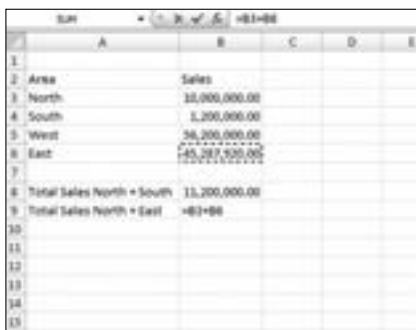


3.1 All About Cell References

Any calculation starts with a cell reference. In Excel 2007 you have 1,048,567 rows and 16,384 columns. The alphabetical columns and the numbered rows intersect to give each cell a unique reference. When you enter values into cells and want to refer to those values elsewhere, you will use the cell reference. See the simple cell reference in the below figure.



The screenshot shows an Excel worksheet with the following data:

	A	B	C	D	E
1					
2	Area	Sales			
3	North	10,000,000.00			
4	South	5,200,000.00			
5	West	36,200,000.00			
6	East	-45,207,500.00			
7					
8	Total Sales North + South	15,200,000.00			
9	Total Sales North + East	=B3+B6			
10					
11					
12					
13					
14					
15					

Simple cell reference

The cell reference can refer to a single cell as in the example above, or to a range of cells in the worksheet (or other worksheets in the same workbook). It can be a simple calculation using the addition, subtraction, division, or multiplication operators, or it can be a complex formula. For example, to total a list of numbers in a row or column, click on the first blank cell next to the numbers and select the ? AutoSum button on the Formulas tab. Excel will automatically select and total the list of preceding numbers.

When you enter cell references into a cell, you will normally enter the "=" sign first. This will inform Excel that you are about to perform a calculation. You can either enter it in directly into the cell or use the formula bar ("fx") at the top. Generally, for simple calculations, it may be convenient to enter it in directly into the cell, and use the formula bar for longer complex cell references and formulas. In any case, as you enter the references to various cells in your cell, Excel will automatically highlight these cells in various colours to help you visually locate where these cells are located. Try it out by copying the above example into a worksheet.